

NEVER AN ADEYEMI

EPISODE 6: THE WAIVER

PALMFIRE SEASON 1

Screenplay draft

Based on Mario's final story brief and story bible

Contemporary Lagos romance with stakes

FADE IN:

INT. OBI FAMILY HOME - FRONT ROOM - PRE-DAWN

Kunle sits opposite Mr. Obi. The brown envelope rests between them. Ify listens from the hallway.

KUNLE

Two million five hundred thousand naira. You sign the waiver and leave the company alone.

MR. OBI

You put a price on silence.

KUNLE

I put a price on peace.

MR. OBI

Peace for whom?

KUNLE

For the people keeping the company alive.

MR. OBI

You mean yourself.

KUNLE

I mean everyone who loses if you become a plaintiff.

Ify hears the word plaintiff and steps into the room.

IFY

You came before sunrise to buy my father's silence.

KUNLE

I came with a practical alternative.

IFY

What does the waiver say?

Kunle closes the envelope.

KUNLE

Ask your father.

CUT TO:

INT. EXECUTOR'S OFFICE - MORNING

Mr. Balogun and Mrs. Eze sit behind two folders: the formal offer and the waiver. Mr. Obi and Ify sit opposite.

MRS. EZE

The waiver is separate from the estate offer.

IFY

It requires permanent withdrawal from the company and the Adeyemi family.

MR. OBI

That is what he brought.

MR. BALOGUN

The estate cannot compel you to accept it.

IFY

He did not need to compel him. He came before sunrise.

MRS. EZE

The formal meeting remains scheduled after the memorial.

MR. OBI

They will use the memorial to tell the story first.

IFY

Then we arrive together.

CUT TO:

INT. ADEYEMI FAMILY HOME - CHIEF'S STUDY - NIGHT

Mrs. Adeyemi opens a locked drawer while Tobi watches.

TOBI

Why are you showing me this?

MRS. ADEYEMI

Because your father kept old papers here when he no longer trusted the company archive.

She touches a small wooden box but does not open it.

TOBI

Is that the proof?

MRS. ADEYEMI

It is the reason he wrote the codicil.

TOBI

Then let Mr. Obi see it.

MRS. ADEYEMI

Your father wanted dignity.

TOBI

Dignity is not silence.

MRS. ADEYEMI

You are asking the family to survive the truth all at once.

TOBI

The family survived the lie for decades.

She locks the box again. Tobi notices the key remains in her hand.

CUT TO:

INT. ADEYEMI FAMILY HOME - MEMORIAL PREPARATION ROOM - DAY

Staff arrange white flowers and printed programmes. Kunle checks the seating plan. Yewande checks her speech.

MRS. ADEYEMI

Mr. Obi should sit with the family.

YEWANDE

He should sit where the cameras can see him.

TOBI

He is not a problem to be staged.

KUNLE

He has the company's future in his hands.

TOBI

He has an offer he has not accepted.

YEWANDE

And a daughter asking questions she does not understand.

Tobi looks toward the locked box on the side table.

TOBI

What is in that box?

MRS. ADEYEMI

Enough to make tomorrow difficult.

CUT TO:

INT. OBI FAMILY HOME - NIGHT

Ify reads the waiver under a single lamp. Mr. Obi sits with the original agreement in his lap.

IFY

It says we disappear. No claims. No conversations. No family contact.

MR. OBI

You do not have to sign anything.

IFY

Neither do you.

MR. OBI

A choice can be heavy and still belong to you.

IFY

They want the choice to look voluntary.

Outside, a car door closes. Ify looks toward the window.

IFY

If we go to the memorial, they will make us part of their story.

MR. OBI

Then let them see us arrive without hiding.

Ify folds the waiver, but does not return it to the envelope.

FADE OUT.